Ali Khamenei: (nods) They endure, like the roots of ancient trees.

Frida Kahlo: (laughs) Ah, roots. They anchor, but they can also trap. Be careful not to let them strangle the vibrant spirit of your people.

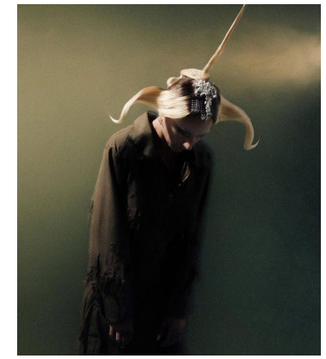
Ali Khamenei: (sternly) Order and discipline are the foundations of a strong nation.

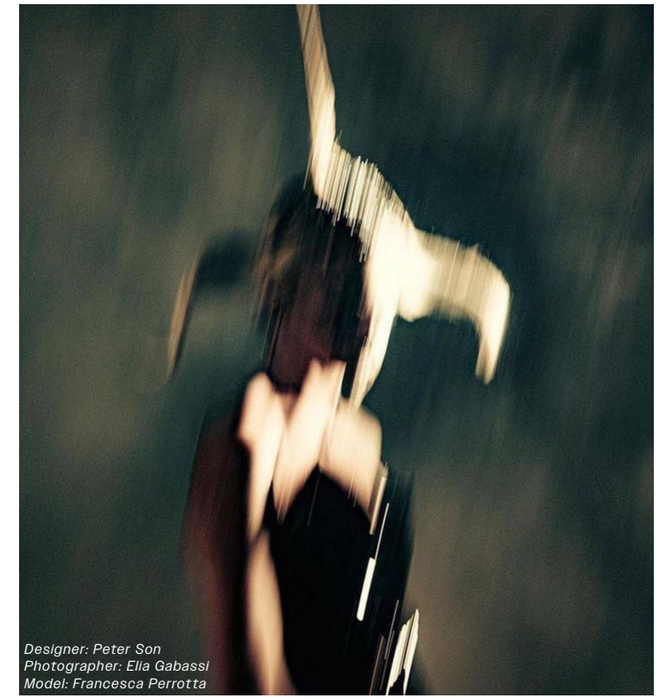
Frida Kahlo: (raises a paintbrush like a scepter) And passion, Senor Khamenei, is the heartbeat that gives it life.

Written by AI
Edited by Aleksandra Eremashvili

In a conversation, where a clash of words and ideologies, where art and politics collided in a surreal dance, the garden absorbed their words, as if the very essence of their discourse transformed the flowers into a living masterpiece, witnessing the intersection of two improbable souls in a conversation that could only exist in the realm of the impossible.

NAVIGATING AND UTOPIAN VISIONS REALITIES





Designer: Peter Son
Photographer: Elia Gabassi
Model: Francesca Perrotta

Within the dynamic realm of Russian fashion, a rich tapestry of contrasts unfolds, weaving together positive and negative consequences, historical influences, the significance of utopian visions, and the unexplored boundaries of menswear.

The Russian fashion landscape, as revealed in this narrative, stands as a double-edged sword. The absence of intense market competition has allowed small Russian brands to thrive, exemplified by the success of “All Around Us.” This brand, specializing in outdoor comfort wear, found fertile ground in the absence of direct European or Russian analogs. However, the downside emerges in the form of potential quality compromise due to the lack of market competition. The wellspring of creativity for this industry transcends mere aesthetics, delving into the historical and natural realms. With a keen eye for authenticity, Peter Son, an emerging fashion designer, draws inspiration from the darker chapters of Russian history, such as the Gulags and the industrial architecture of the communist era. These somber realities serve as a foundation for the creative process, adding depth to the narrative woven into each design. Amidst the challenges and triumphs, let’s emphasize the vital role of utopian visions in representing Russian reality. While acknowledging the necessity of addressing current issues, the infusion of utopian ideas becomes a beacon of hope. It serves as a reminder to both designers and consumers to dream of a brighter future, transcending the immediate challenges faced by contemporary Russia.

In the realm of menswear, we also delve into the complexities of breaking societal norms. Specifically, crafting menswear dresses becomes a delicate dance to make traditionally feminine garments exude masculine strength. The challenge lies not only in the design but in challenging societal perceptions, allowing men to feel strong and self-confident even in attire traditionally deemed exclusive to women. To illustrate, small brands such as Namilia should be applauded for

their commitment to true equality and diversity, celebrating their impact on the fashion industry. These brands become beacons of change, challenging conventions and fostering a celebration of individuality within an industry often bound by tradition. As Gosha Rubchinskiy, a leading Russian fashion designer, stylist and photographer, the contemporary designers in Russia contemplate the nature of utopia, deeming it inherently unattainable and, therefore, a realm of dreams. This personal pursuit of inspiration and importance becomes a creative journey, with acceptance or disagreement from others being secondary. The essence lies in the act of personal expression and the intrinsic value found in creative inspiration. Reflecting on utopian ideas across generations, we note that dreaming about the future is often a characteristic of the young. This feature is born out of the contrast between European and Russian youth, with the former often fighting for absolute equality and freedom, while the latter grapples with more fundamental human rights issues, reflecting the unique sociopolitical landscapes.

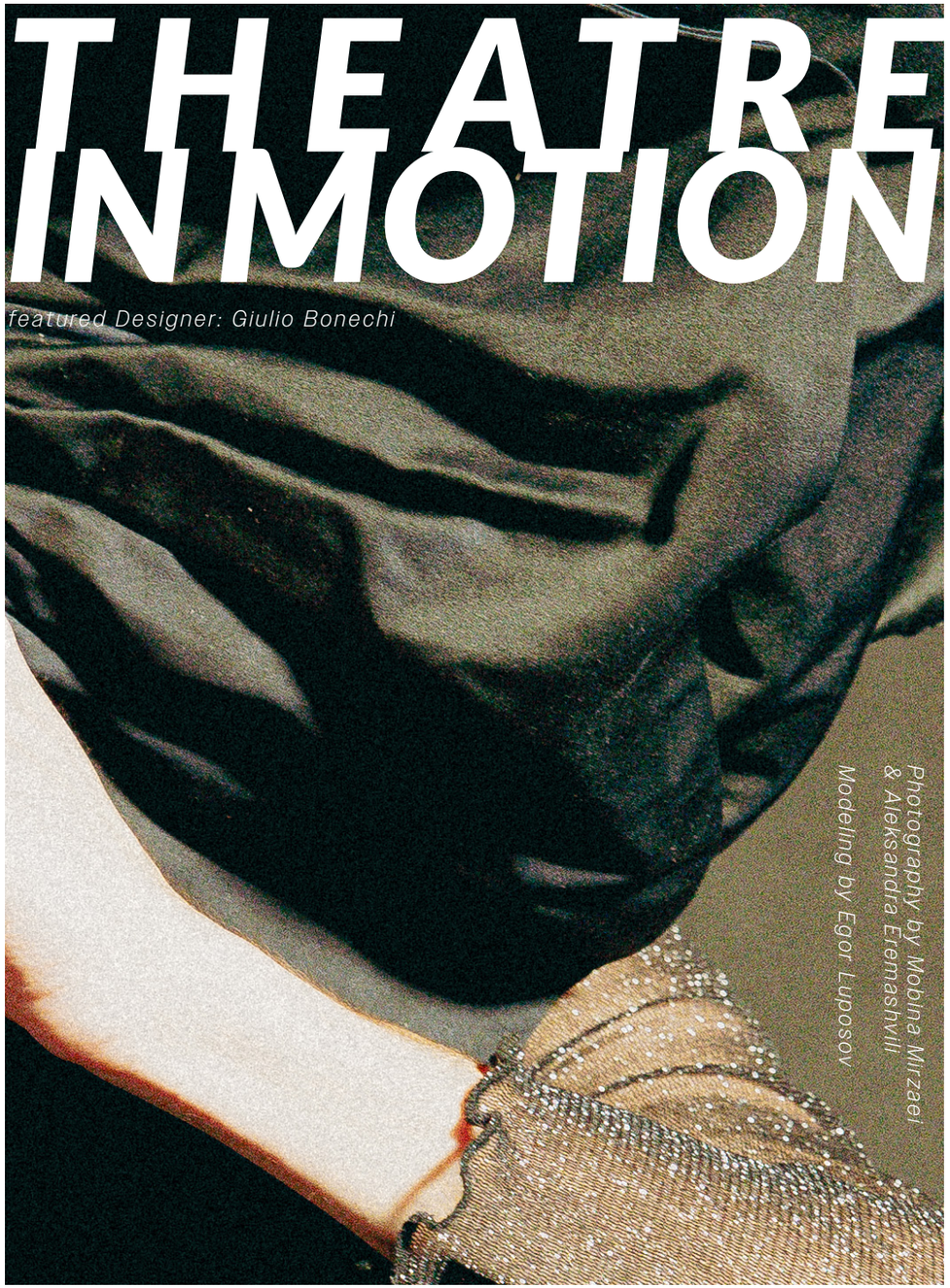
Talking about trends, by their transient nature, they satisfy momentary desires, while utopia demands persistent effort and unwavering dedication. Once utopia is achieved, it should endure, leaving an indelible mark on the ever-evolving canvas of the fashion industry.

In essence, the multifaceted world of Russian contemporary menswear fashion is a contemplative journey that sheds light on the delicate balance between tradition and innovation, challenges and triumphs, and the timeless pursuits of utopian ideals that shape the narrative of this dynamic industry.

Written by Aleksandra Eremashvili

THEATRE IN MOTION

featured Designer: Giulio Bonechi



Photography by Mobina Mirzaei & Aleksandra Eremashvili

Modeling by Egor Luposov